HongSeok Kim

Updated October 7, 2026

Email: hongseok@iastate.edu **Website**: https://hongseokimm.github.io **Phone**: (515) 230-8154
Citizenship: Republic of Korea (F1)

Education

Iowa State University — Iowa, USA
Ph.D. in Economics — 2021 – 2027 (Expected)
Advisor: Professor Juan Carlos Córdoba.

Hanyang University — Seoul, Republic of Korea
M.A. in Economics and Finance — 2021
B.A. in Economics and Finance — 2019

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Public Economics, Economics of Aging

Job Market Paper

[1] **The Intergenerational Welfare Cost of Social Security Insolvency** [pdf]

Abstract. This paper asks which generations bear the welfare cost of Social Security insolvency. The trust fund is expected to be depleted in 2033, but each generation meets it at a different age, with different years of benefits at stake and different means of adjusting. In a life-cycle model with endogenous saving, labor supply, human capital, and claiming, I quantify how the expected duration of reduced payments shifts that welfare incidence. The main result is that the cohort losing the most unpaid dollars is not the cohort losing the most welfare. Households that expect the shortfall self-insure by saving, working, and human-capital investment, but the cost of doing so depends on age. The youngest cohorts spread the adjustment over a career, whereas mid-career cohorts must compress it into the years before retirement and end up worse off than if the shortfall had been a surprise. Duration matters as well. When the shortfall is brief, the burden lands mainly on retirees, and when it is prolonged, the burden shifts to the working generations behind them.

Working Paper

[1] **Fertility Inertia under Ambiguity Aversion** [pdf]

Abstract. High family-policy spending often produces only small changes in fertility. I study this problem in a Barro–Becker model. Parents value descendants' utility, dislike risk in its total value, and assess family plans by their worst-case value. They are uncertain about how well public news predicts children's outcomes. Information inertia creates an interval of bad news in which welfare falls but locally optimal fertility, investment per child, and consumption remain unchanged. Reliable subsidies can still raise fertility. An explicit policy solution discounts uncertain benefits by the lowest possible delivery rate. Thus, unclear delivery requires larger promises for the same fertility response. More effective support raises fertility and shifts and widens the inertia interval. Less uncertainty about signal informativeness narrows it for a fixed family plan. This suggests two policy dimensions: generosity and legibility. The exact inertia result is limited to maxmin preferences, continuous fertility, and a local normal representation.

Work in Progress

[1] **Optimal Immigration Policy under Private Information** [pdf]

Fellowships & Awards

Graduate Teaching Excellence Award (Top 10%), Iowa State University	2026
Professional Advancement Grants (PAG), Iowa State University	2026
Graduate Student Workshop Fellowship, Western Economic Association International	2026
Summer Teaching Assistantship, Iowa State University	2025
Most Engaging Presentation Award, EGSA, Iowa State University	2025
Best Discussant Award, EGSA, Iowa State University	2025
Research Travel Grant ($750) × 6, Iowa State University	2023–2026
Brain Korea 21 Plus Scholarship, Hanyang University	2020–2021
Academic Scholarship HY-IN Graduate School Scholarship, Hanyang University	2020
Academic Fellowship Korea Student Aid Foundation Fellowship	2019
Graduation Award, Hanyang University	2019

Seminar & Conference

96th Southern Economic Association, Houston†	2026
Midwest Macro Fall Meetings, Texas Tech University†	2026
21th Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis†	2026
Econometric Society in Dynamic Structural Econometrics, University of Michigan	2026
101th Western Economic Association International	2026
North American Summer Meeting Econometric Society (NASM), Emory University	2026
Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society (AMES), Vietnam (Accepted, but cancelled)	2026
Workshop on AI and Machine Learning for Economists, Iowa State University	2025
Southern Economic Association, Washington D.C	2024
19th Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis	2024
Midwest Macro Fall Meetings, Purdue University	2024
Macro Reading Group, Iowa State University	2024
Midwest Economic Association, Chicago	2023

†Scheduled.

Academic Experience

Sole Instructor — Iowa State University

ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics — Summer, 2025
(Eval: 4.36/5.0)

Recitation Instructor – Graduate — Iowa State University

ECON 6040: Advanced Macroeconomics Analysis — 2024S, 2025S, 2026S
(Ph.D. Core, Eval: 5.0/5.0)

ECON 6020: Macroeconomic Analysis — 2025F
(Ph.D. Core, Eval: 5.0/5.0)

ECON 6030: Advanced Microeconomics - Game Theory — 2023S
(Ph.D. Core, Eval: 4.67/5.0)

ECON 5710: Intermediate Econometrics — 2026S
(Masters, Eval: 4.5/5.0)

ECON 5000: Quantitative Methods in Economic Analysis I — 2026F
(Masters, Current)

Teaching Assistant/Lab Instructor – Undergraduate — Iowa State University

ECON 3020: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Eval: 5.0/5.0) — 2025

ECON 3710: Introduction to Econometrics (Eval: 4.29/5.0) — 2021

ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics — 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

ECON 1010: Principles of Microeconomics — 2021, 2023, 2024

Academic Service

Discussions

"Urbanicity and Fertility: Evidence from Refugees to Canada",
– Midwest Economics Association Meetings, Chicago — 2024

Guest Lecture

ECON3270 (Economics of Discrimination)
– Quantity-Quality Trade-off of Gary Becker's Model — 2025

Other Service

Economic Help Room Services for the Undergraduates — 2021, 2023

Skills

Fortran (OpenMP/MPI), Python, Julia, Stata

References

Juan Carlos Córdoba
Major professor
Professor, Department of Economics
Iowa State University, Ames, IA
cordoba@iastate.edu

Rajesh Singh
Committee member
Professor, Department of Economics
Iowa State University, Ames, IA
rsingh@iastate.edu

Quinn Weninger
Committee member
Professor, Department of Economics
Iowa State University, Ames, IA
weninger@iastate.edu